

THE TAVERN TREMORS

This tavern is a popular place for Pompeiians to buy a meal or a jug of wine. Normally, people would be catching up on the latest news while they order, but today the atmosphere is uneasy. The usual earthquakes are happening more frequently, and people are beginning to get scared.

Takeout toppings

Pompeiians ate lots of fruit and vegetables, along with fish, nuts, olives, and lentils. The eruption turned some food to charcoal, perfectly preserving it for thousands of years.



The remains of carbonized figs

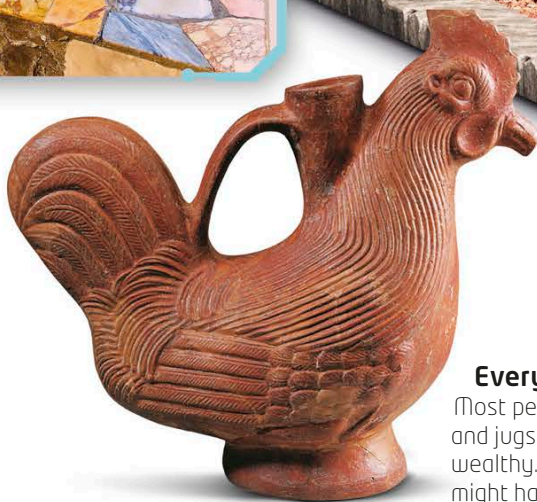


Walnuts



Over the counter

A Roman snack bar was called a *thermopolium*. It sold fast food, ladling out ready-cooked meals from big terra-cotta pots that were set into the countertop. Popular meals included soups, stews, and bread and cheese.



Everyday jug

Most people would have used plates, cups, and jugs made of clay, or bronze if they were wealthy. This jug in the shape of a chicken might have held water or wine.

Many Roman businesses painted their names on their buildings.

